

Phase 2 – Week 1 – Day 1 Home Assignment

Home Assignments – n8n

Assignment 1 – Explore n8n Case Studies

Go through the n8n case studies and understand how real enterprise organizations are using n8n.
Focus on:

- What problem/use case they had
- Where and why they implemented n8n
- How the workflow was implemented
- How n8n helped them in real-world scenarios
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<https://n8n.io/case-studies/>

I reviewed the official n8n Stepstone case study. Stepstone is a large European job platform, and its n8n journey is a good example of how an automation tool can grow from a small team experiment into an enterprise-wide automation platform.

1. What problem/use case did Stepstone have?

Stepstone initially had **manual and repetitive operational activities** across different teams.

The company was dealing with:

- Large volumes of job-related data and documents.
- Data routing and internal reporting activities.
- Operational fixes that required technical involvement.
- Repetitive customer-service tasks.
- Teams needing access to external APIs and data.
- Increasing demand from employees to automate their own work.

2. Where and why did they implement n8n?

Initially, they used the **Community Edition**. After several years, their usage grew significantly and they moved to **n8n Enterprise**.

The main reasons for moving to Enterprise were:

Requirement	Why it mattered
Credential management	Avoid sharing credentials between users
Workflow permissions	Control who could access or modify workflows
Role-based access	Allow different teams to work independently
Execution monitoring	Better visibility into workflow execution
Version control	Better management of production workflows
Security	Protect sensitive employee/GDPR-related information
Scalability	Support hundreds of workflows and thousands of employees

3. How was the workflow implemented?

Stepstone's implementation can be understood in **two major parts: technical infrastructure and employee onboarding**.

A. Enterprise infrastructure

Stepstone implemented enterprise capabilities including:

SSO → Okta

Employees can use centralized authentication rather than separate credentials.

External secret management

Sensitive credentials can be stored externally instead of being shared individually between users.

Role-based access

Different teams can have their own areas and permissions.

Separate environment for IT Security

The IT security team operates its own n8n instance for sensitive workflows involving GDPR-regulated employee data.

4. How did n8n help them in real-world scenarios?

This is the strongest part of the Stepstone case study.

Use Case 1 – Automating contract mappings

Problem:

60–70 contract mappings were accumulating every day.

Manual process:

Each mapping required approximately 2–3 minutes.

n8n solution:

Luka created an n8n workflow to process the mappings automatically.

Result:

The complete daily batch was reduced to approximately **20 seconds**.

5. What were the measurable results?

The results demonstrate how Stepstone moved from experimentation to enterprise adoption.

Area	Result
Employees	~3,000 employees being enabled for automation
Production workflows	700+
Previous workflow volume	~200 one year earlier
Job-related documents processed	2–3 million/month
Contract mapping process	Reduced to ~20 seconds
Product cleanup	Reduced to ~30 minutes
API access	Data retrieved immediately instead of waiting weeks
Security	Dedicated n8n environment for sensitive IT security workflows

Area	Result
Adoption	Started with a few early adopters and expanded organically
These figures are reported in the official n8n case study.	

6. Why was n8n successful at Stepstone?

The case study highlights an important pattern:

Early adopters → Demonstrable value → Employee interest → Training → More automation → Enterprise adoption

Stepstone did not start with a huge enterprise-wide implementation.

It started with **one engineer**.

That engineer demonstrated useful results. Other teams saw those results and became interested. As adoption increased, Stepstone added the enterprise security, governance and onboarding capabilities needed to scale.

This created what Stepstone describes as an **organic cycle of adoption**.

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Assignment 2 – Explore & Build an n8n Template

Open the Templates section in n8n and explore the available workflow templates (12,000+).

- Explore different workflows and understand what they are doing.
- Choose any one template/use case of your interest.
- Understand the complete workflow, nodes, integrations, and flow.
- Try to build/recreate the workflow yourself in n8n.

The objective is not just to copy the template, but to understand why each node is used and how the complete workflow solves a real-world problem.

Template Chosen for build/ recreate the workflow in n8n:

<https://n8n.io/workflows/2090-chat-with-a-database-using-ai/>

Chat with a database using AI

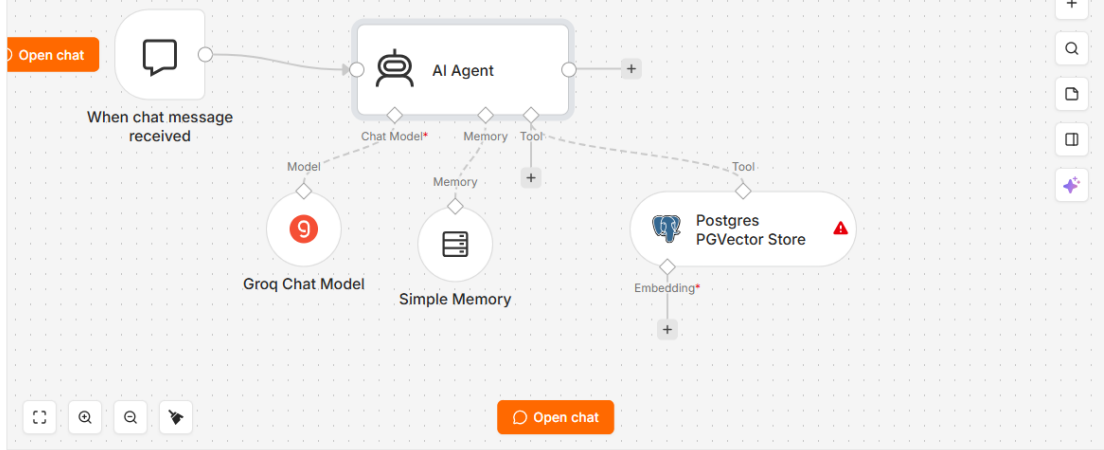


- n8n
- n8n Assistant
- Overview

Personal / My workflow 5

Publish

Editor Executions Evaluations



- Templates
- Insights
- Help

Postgres PGVector Store

Docs

INPUT

MappingFrom AI

→|

No input data

Execute previous nodes

to view input data

ParametersSettingsExecute step

Tip: Get a feel for vector stores in n8n with our [RAG starter template](#)

Credential

Postgres account

Operation Mode

Retrieve Documents (As Tool for AI Agent)

Description

e.g. Work with your data in Postgresql with the PGVector extension

Table Name

n8n_vectors

Limit

4

Embedding *

OUTPUT

|→

No output data

Execute step

or [set mock data](#)